



WEBSITE PLAN · CURRENT DIRECTION

A trusted local home for The Family Center

Strategy, site structure, Wagtail plan, technical foundations, launch requirements, and open decisions in one place.

Commander's Intent approved

Full site plan still in planning

AUDIENCE

Families, community members, local businesses, and supporters

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Django + Wagtail + server-rendered templates

FIRST LAUNCH

Public information, events, contact, and external giving links

IMPLEMENTATION

Wagtail foundation started; full site and launch content remain in progress

What the site is for

Build and continually improve a trusted, accessible, mobile-first, locally discoverable website that helps The Family Center advance its purpose of preparing elementary- and middle-school students to enter high school ready to thrive. Make CEO-approved information about the nonprofit's verified mission, current work, events, and ways to connect easy for families and supporters to find and use, while keeping future aspirations distinct from current services. Give the organization secure, maintainable tools to grow the site over time without exposing draft content or collecting more personal information than necessary.

This is the approved project-wide intent. The owner has also approved the website-specific intent recorded in the decision log.

02 · STRATEGY

Story and visitor paths

Families and community members are the primary audience, and the site's main job is to make it easy for them to find and attend events. Businesses and supporters are secondary audiences. The site must distinguish verified current work from future aspirations.

Bring people together
Community events and fundraisers connect families, volunteers, businesses, and supporters.

Meet immediate needs
School-supply support is a possible part of the story; verify whether it is current before describing it as active work.

Build toward the future
More consistent youth-development opportunities are an aspiration until programs, capacity, and details are confirmed.

Families and community members
Find accurate event information, understand practical details, and decide whether and how to participate.

Businesses and larger supporters
Understand the verified work, explore giving or partnership options, and contact the organization.

Content discipline: All draft copy, claims, dates, addresses, sponsorship benefits, image permissions, and service descriptions need owner/CEO confirmation before publication. The provisional avatar and its assumptions are planning aids, not research findings.

Page types and navigation

Page / type	Purpose	Initial status
HomePage	Explain the organization and offer clear paths to events and business support; highlight approved upcoming events.	One custom, designed Wagtail template with editable approved content.
About	Present the organization's approved story and background.	Separate standard Wagtail page; public wording requires owner/CEO approval.
What We Do	Explain verified current work and distinguish it from future aspirations.	Separate standard Wagtail page; no unlaunched services presented as current.
EventsIndexPage	Show upcoming and past events from their canonical event records.	Wagtail page in the Events app.
EventPage	Provide one stable page per event with date, time, place, cost, eligibility, schedule, and a real action.	Wagtail page with structured per-event fields; publish only after event details and the action are confirmed. Event cards are generated from these records.
Business Partnerships	Explain confirmed ways local businesses can help and provide a contact path.	Standard editorial page; package/recognition details need CEO approval.
Business Partner profiles	Recognize approved partners with name, logo, website, neutral acknowledgment, and an event-sponsor label when applicable.	Partners app and Wagtail-managed profiles; business contacts do not get site accounts. CEO and business contact approve the exact sponsor wording; tiers and benefits remain open.
Donate	Provide a direct giving route and verified nonprofit/tax/gift-use information.	External donation provider at first launch; no in-site payment processing.
Contact	Offer the contact form and a verified organization email address.	Wagtail ContactPage plus separately managed contact submissions; email is pending CEO confirmation.
Gallery / Programs	Show approved photos or active ongoing offerings.	Defer gallery until rights/consent are checked; add program pages only when offerings are confirmed.

Navigation draft: Home · Events · What We Do · About · Business Partnerships · Contact, with a prominent “Partner with us” action. Donate, Get Involved, Gallery, and Privacy Notice are proposed supporting/footer links. Confirm the final structure after content review.

Separate apps for separate jobs

Django app	Owns
accounts	Custom Django user model and account behavior. Initial users: owner superuser and CEO staff/editor. No public registration at launch.
pages	HomePage, standard information page types, reusable page blocks, and shared editorial page behavior.
events	Events index, individual event pages, and upcoming/past date logic.
contact	Stored inquiries, notifications, permissions, and retention/deletion.
partners	Business supporter records and the no-account, email-based profile approval workflow.

A homepage is a Wagtail page type, not a separate app. Wagtail supplies the CEO's page-editing interface; use Jazzmin to theme Django admin for the developer. No custom “admin app” is planned unless a real custom workflow is needed. Payment and program apps are deferred until those workflows are approved.

How the homepage concept fits Wagtail

The HTML mockup is a static visual concept, not a Wagtail page. Its custom section order, styling, and presentation belong in a Django template. Wagtail stores the approved heading/copy, image choices, links, and featured-event selection. Editors change content; they do not rearrange arbitrary page layouts.

- **Shared shell:** project-level `templates/base.html` with shared navbar/footer includes and a named content block.
- **Page templates:** app-owned, namespaced templates such as `pages/home_page.html` and `events/event_page.html`, each extending the shared base.
- **Wagtail blocks:** Python definitions in app modules such as `pages/blocks.py`; optional HTML renderers live under namespaced app template folders. Use `StreamField` only for developer-approved editable components.
- **Interactions:** small Alpine behaviors live in the page/partial markup or bundled static JavaScript, not in block definitions.

Wagtail 8.0 is integrated with Python 3.14.7 and Django 5.2.x. The custom user model, page/event models, contact inquiry model, starter templates, and initial Wagtail site tree are in place. Direct local SQLite development now uses `db-wagtail.sqlite3` so the pre-Wagtail scaffold database remains untouched.

Who can do what

Separate admin experiences

Use Jazzmin for the developer's full-access Django admin and Wagtail for the CEO's event-page editing. Navigation and styling are configured separately; Jazzmin does not theme Wagtail.

User	Interface and access	Navigation, appearance, and landing page
Developer / owner	Django admin superuser with full access; Wagtail developer tools as needed.	Jazzmin dark theme and full app/model menu. Keep the standard index; add a custom dashboard only if useful.
CEO	Wagtail editor, below superuser: create, edit, and publish EventPages under EventsIndexPage without review. No Django-model access.	Focus navigation on pages/events. Keep Wagtail's standard landing page; defer a custom dashboard.

Use the organization's logo and site identity in both interfaces. Candidate asset: `media/legacy-site/data/files/tfc_logo_p2__1__1_-removebg-preview-1.png`. Local media is git-ignored, so confirm its durable production location when wiring it in. Jazzmin's dark theme applies to Django admin; Wagtail styling is separate.

- Create a custom user model before the first organization-specific migrations.
- Create separate owner and CEO accounts. Keep the CEO below superuser and restrict Wagtail permissions to event content; the CEO can publish event pages directly.
- No public login or business partner accounts at launch. Add editors only when requested, with least-privilege Wagtail groups.
- Businesses submit profile details without accounts. TFC staff verify permission and draft the profile; an authorized business contact reviews an exact-version email preview and explicitly approves it before publication. The approval action must be a one-time, expiring, revision-bound, CSRF-protected POST; opening a link must never publish.

Contact, donations, and tracking

- The contact form collects only name, email, and message. Store submissions until resolved; notify the CEO. Give the owner and CEO a limited Wagtail inbox to review and resolve inquiries, without general Django-model access for the CEO.
- Delete resolved messages after 90 days and unresolved messages after one year at the latest. Do not solicit sensitive details about children in a general contact form.
- Use external donation and event-registration links at first launch. Do not process payments or store card data in Django.
- Plan for Google Analytics and Search Console with owner-provided access. No advertising pixels unless separately approved and covered by the privacy approach.

Photo handling

Only upload photos after reuse permission and required subject/guardian consent are confirmed, especially for young people. The CEO may publish approved images. Add accurate alt text after visual review.

Build and data flow

Local CEO demo

SQLite database for Wagtail content authoring and demonstration.

Local rehearsal

Docker Compose PostgreSQL service runs on the developer's machine for migration and schema rehearsal; do not copy the SQLite database file.

Production

Linode-hosted PostgreSQL and planned Linode Object Storage for durable media.

Keep the schema portable with Django migrations. Initialize production PostgreSQL from those migrations, then enter the CEO-approved launch pages directly in production Wagtail. Do not copy or rsync `db.sqlite3` to the Linode server: PostgreSQL cannot use a SQLite database file, and copying it moves the entire database rather than only approved public content. Create production accounts separately. Wagtail Transfer may be evaluated later if repeated promotion justifies a hosted staging source; test page dependencies and media bytes before adopting it.

Tunnel rule: An SSH tunnel connects to the real remote database; it is not a local copy. Do not use Linode PostgreSQL as the routine target for local development. Use local SQLite or the local Compose PostgreSQL service.

Media snapshot

Thirty-two images from the public site were downloaded under the git-ignored `media/legacy-site/` folder, with source URLs in its manifest. Their permissions and people depicted have not been verified. Media files are not stored in Git; transfer approved assets to object storage separately from database records.

Stack and tests

Current project: Python 3.14.7, Django 5.2.x, Wagtail 8.0, PostgreSQL in Docker Compose, and SQLite for local demo work. Planned frontend: Django templates, Tailwind CSS, daisyUI, and Alpine.js for small interactions. The initial server-rendered templates and semantic design tokens are in place; the five theme variants remain to be built.

Write tests with each feature and organize them so a single test, app suite, or focused group can run independently. Required security coverage includes CSRF, authentication, role/object permissions, and payment boundaries when introduced.

```
python manage.py test app.tests.unit.test_models.ModelTests.test_expected_behavior
python manage.py test app.tests.unit app.tests.security
python manage.py test app
python manage.py test
```

SEO and site-quality baseline

- ☐ Unique, accurate title and description for every public page.
- ☐ Stable readable URLs, self-consistent canonical URLs, and redirects for replaced legacy paths.
- ☐ Production `robots.txt` allows approved public content and points to the XML sitemap; local/demo/staging uses access controls and noindex protections.
- ☐ XML sitemap contains only published, canonical, indexable pages—not drafts, admin pages, previews, or avatar variants.
- ☐ Organization and event structured data matches verified content visible on the page.
- ☐ Approved favicon/browser icons, social preview metadata, image alt text, mobile usability, accessible focus/contrast, and fast loading.
- ☐ Consistent verified name, address, phone, and service area; confirm the Google Business Profile with the owner.
- ☐ After launch, verify Search Console, submit the sitemap, and review indexing and coverage.

Favicons support site identity and browser usability; they are not a search-ranking factor. No ranking result is guaranteed. Analytics, pixels, and privacy statements must match the tools actually enabled.

Launch sequence

1. Finish strategy and content ideas; confirm active services, public facts, business support terms, event details, and audience direction.
2. Finish owner/CEO review of the full plan; the website-specific Commander's Intent is approved.
3. Continue the Wagtail foundation; choose and test a compatible Jazzmin version; configure the developer's dark Jazzmin admin and the CEO's event-focused Wagtail publishing access; complete accounts, pages, events, contact, and partners with migrations and focused tests.
4. Review and approve content, media, contact/privacy rules, and SEO metadata.
5. Build the local SQLite CEO demo; rehearse migrations against local PostgreSQL. After CEO approval, enter the selected public content directly in the fresh production Wagtail site.
6. Deploy to Linode only after the plan and launch content are approved; provision the production superuser and CEO account separately.
7. Move approved media to object storage, verify redirects/robots/sitemap/schema/mobile/accessibility, then connect owner-managed Analytics and Search Console.
8. After the owner verifies the CEO-selected content in production, archive the demo/source JSON and remove unselected content alternatives from the public site.

Open questions for the owner and CEO

Organization and content

- Review the synthesized mission and vision drafts with the CEO and define “thrive in high school”; verify whether school-supply support is current.
- Next real events and complete logistics.
- Business sponsorship options, donation use, recognition/benefits, nonprofit/tax wording, and shareable evidence.
- Confirm public address and remaining contact details; service area is Winston-Salem, North Carolina.

Operations and launch

- Confirm the public organization email and sender/provider with the CEO; contact retention is set to 90 days after resolution, with a one-year maximum for unresolved inquiries.
- Verify photo reuse permission and required consent.
- Confirm Google Business Profile access, exact URL redirects, and analytics measurement actions.
- Choose a compatible Jazzmin version. Wagtail 8.0 compatibility has passed an isolated smoke test; a full Wagtail Transfer round-trip is optional future work.

Planning status: The project and plan-specific Commander's Intents are approved, and the Wagtail foundation is underway. The full public site and approved content are not complete. Draft copy, event placeholders, partnership terms, and unverified facts are not approved for publication.

Prepared from the project brief, technical conventions, decision log, current source-site inventory, and local homepage concept. Internal planning document; not public copy. Last reviewed: 26 September 2026.